

Jake Howden

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Cardiff, South Wales

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Cloud-native .NET engineer with 7+ years designing event-driven platforms on AWS and Azure. I have tackled a range of problems, worked with cross-functional teams, and engineered features that improve customer experience and revenue metrics.

Education

University of South Wales

BSc (Hons) Computer Games Development

First-Class Honours

09/2015–06/2018

Technical Skills

Programming

C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET Core, CosmosDB, DynamoDB, TDD, xUnit, Kafka, SQS/SNS, ServiceBus

Architecture

Cloud, Microservices, Event Driven, Domain-Driven Design, CQRS, HTTP, Messaging

DevOps

Terraform, Helm Charts, Serverless, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Infrastructure as Code

Cloud

AWS, Azure, Serverless, Kubernetes, Docker, AWS Lambda, Azure Functions

Experience

Confused.com (RVU)

Cardiff, United Kingdom

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

02/2026–Present

- Set the architecture for a new client-facing portal on AKS replacing manual account management, validating the Cloudflare, App Gateway WAF and Nginx ingress with the platform team and isolating test from live traffic on Event Hubs.
- Averted a second portal build by making the case for folding a legacy internal portal into the new one, aligning four stakeholders one-to-one before the decision; then led the phased migration planning.
- Cut the time to stand up production services from 3 days to 22 minutes by co-building a multi-agent AI orchestrator that builds and deploys them from an architecture diagram, gated on PR merge, ArgoCD rollout and a reviewer agent.
- Established an Architecture Decision Record practice used by 15+ teams: built a GitHub Pages site collating ADRs across repos, standardised the format with another team, and pitched it to the Staff+ engineering forum.
- Consolidated 4 teams' divergent CI pipelines into reusable GitHub Actions templates, giving services leaving Azure DevOps a ready-made migration path; since adopted on platforms beyond the originating team.
- Drove Claude Code adoption outside engineering, onboarding 18 staff in 3 sessions with a setup guide other guilds reused.

Just Eat Takeaway

Bristol, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

09/2024–02/2026

- Engineered and architected an event-driven platform generating €243 million in annual revenue.
- Migrated legacy services from EC2 to Kubernetes (EKS), reducing infrastructure spend by 30%.
- Standardised our messaging framework to eliminate duplicated code and reduce complexity across microservices.
- Integrated E2E test suites into CI/CD pipelines, strengthening release gates and improving service reliability.
- Championed multiple features which improved agent efficiency and customer satisfaction.
- Mentored senior developers transitioning to .NET, offering guidance in engineering and testing best practices.

Ensono

Remote, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE CONSULTANT

04/2022–07/2024

- Successfully delivered a marketing system overhaul for Next PLC, migrating on-prem monoliths to cloud microservices in a £5 million contract.
- Designed and implemented CI/CD pipelines to deploy services to Azure Kubernetes Service.
- Co-led a £1.2 million initiative rebuilding admissions and finance communications for a London university with Azure Functions and Azure Service Bus.
- Applied TDD, automated regression suites, and infrastructure-as-code to sustain high deployment confidence.
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops and roadmap reviews that aligned engineering deliverables with business milestones.

Tytonical

Remote, United Kingdom

BACKEND DEVELOPER

06/2020–04/2022

- Owned end-to-end delivery of back-end web APIs and full-stack applications for fintech and media clients.
- Prioritised scalability and high availability when designing AWS ECS deployments, ensuring cost-efficient operations.
- Brokered partner integrations by defining APIs, SLAs, and support processes that kept joint launches on schedule.
- Mentored interns through structured workshops and pair-programming, progressing them to production-ready contributors.

Newpark Solutions

Bristol, United Kingdom

APP MANAGER

01/2019–06/2020

- Directed a full redesign of the parking payment app, coordinating product, design, and engineering across release cycles.
- Led customer support and QA teams, instituting feedback loops that tightened defect triage and response times.
- Maintained and extended backend web services to onboard new municipal clients and payment features.
- Raised the app store rating from 1.5–2 to 4+, improving brand perception and retention.

Newpark Solutions

Bristol, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

06/2018–01/2019

- Integrated a new payment service provider for in-app payments, improving checkout reliability and compliance.
- Built automated payment services that delivered a frictionless parking experience for customers.